Family members will often associate themselves and the rest of the family with family property more than anything else, especially in families that do not have family businesses.

Family property is where family members most often come together. You want to keep property as a unifier, not a divider. So avoid dividing up properties among family members as much as possible. Avoid arguments about how to manage and maintain properties. Talk it out. Compromise.

Family gatherings on family property offer an excellent opportunity to strengthen family bonds. These should be held at major holidays, and preferably, there should be a gathering to celebrate an event that is completely unique to the family. Weddings. Funerals. Graduations. Use family properties to mark important family milestones.

Family Investments

What your family chooses to invest in also makes up a big part of your family's identity.

How does your family manage wealth? How will it do so in the future? What sorts of investments does your family favor and why? Who will participate in managing the family money?

These things are all expressions of your family culture. And they reflect the unique style of your family. That is why it is so important that you have a group in place to look after your family's investment decisions. When you make an investment decision, you make a statement about your family's culture.

Look on each investment you make as an opportunity to expand and enrich your family culture. You want family members to view family investments as consistent with the family culture.

Our family has a few unique traditions and rituals that help promote our family culture. As children grow up, for instance, they are invited to accompany their father on business trips. These usually take the family to far-flung places where the family has an outpost. We have been to Hong Kong, South Africa, India, China, and many other locations. We remember the trips. We learn from them, too.